

A plot against Paul is discovered.

Acts 23:12-35

Paul traveled everywhere, telling many people the good news about Jesus. When he was in Jerusalem, some of the religious leaders who did not love Jesus heard Paul talking about Jesus. They got very angry and had Paul put in jail.

Forty of the men who did not love Jesus promised each other that they wouldn't eat any food or even drink any water until they had killed Paul. Paul's nephew heard about the plan to kill Paul. He went straight to visit his uncle Paul in jail. He told him what he had heard. Paul called one of the guards. "Take this young man to the commander," Paul said. "He has something to tell him."

Paul's nephew went to the commander. "The angry men want to hurt Paul," the nephew said. "Forty men plan to kill him!"

The commander wanted to keep Paul safe. So he called for 200 soldiers, 70 men on horses and 200 men with spears. During the night, all 470 men and their horses started walking out of the city. What a parade! Somewhere in the middle of all those soldiers was Paul! The 40 men waiting to hurt Paul never saw him! Paul had escaped! Now he could keep telling people about Jesus!